# Elk expert talks at MORE show

In the world of elk hunting, few hunters have compiled the record of Don Laubach.

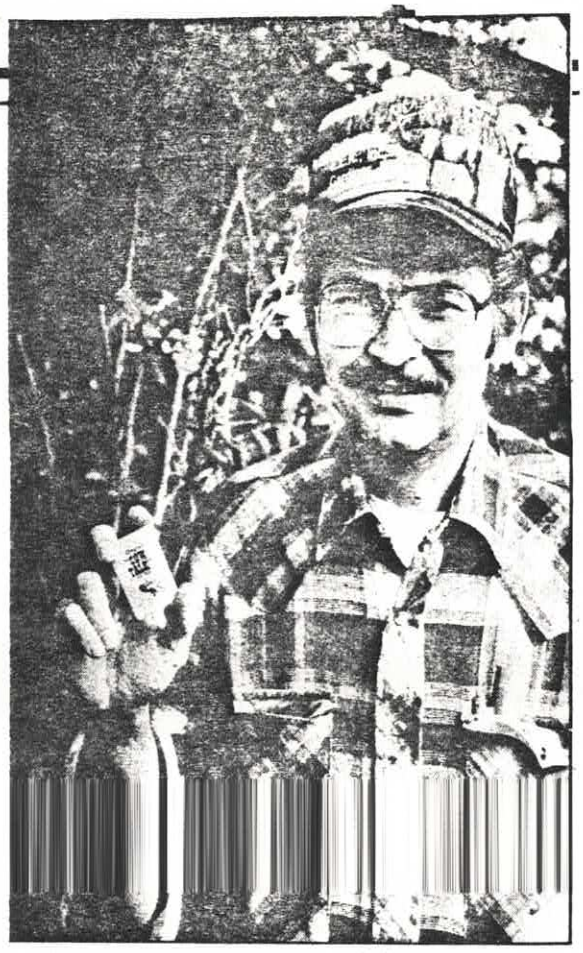
Laubach, of Gardiner, took 13 elk in 13 years with a bow and has shot countless others with a rifle over an elk hunting career that has spanned nearly four decades.

He broke into national prominence when he developed the Cow Talk call which imitates the sounds of cows and calves and has been an effective tool for the elk hunter during the bow season, gun season and even the late hunts.

Since then, he has been featured on elk hunting videos through Eastman's Outdoor World and has co-authored the book "Elk Talk" with Billings Gazette Outdoor Editor Mark Henckel.

Laubach will talk about elk calling, elk hunting in all seasons and will be one of the judges for the elk calling competition at the MORE show.

He will talk about elk hunting in the speaker's theater at 3 p.m. Saturday and Sunday.



Don Laubach made cow call famous.



Don Laubach is the founder and president of E.L.K., Inc. He is the inventor and patent holder on the "Cow Talk" call and the "Larynx Bull Call" for elk and the "Antelope Talk," "Deer Talk," and "Turkey Talk" calls. With co-author Mark Henckel, his books include *Elk Talk, The Elk Hunter, Deer Talk,* and now *Elk Tactics.* Laubach also was involved in creating a number of successful videos with legendary filmmaker Gordon Eastman and has more recently begun creating videos of his own, including *Wyoming's Thunder Bulls, Mule Deer Advantage,* and *Dogging Coyotes.* All are available from E.L.K., Inc., P.O. Box 85, Gardiner, MT, 59030.

# *Review:* ELK TALK

## by Don Laubach & Mark Henckel

Innovation, when it comes to elk hunting, is often met with resistance harbored in tradition or experience. New methods or products must be discovered, practiced, and then proven, often by a skeptical individual who considers attempting them in the field. Tried and true tactics are seldom abandoned. New methods are rarely adopted. In the last ten years bugling has become extremely popular, tandem with the growth of archery elk hunting that began in the 60's. Many say that because of the proliferation of bugling hunters, today's elk are call-wise. They are harder to call and do most of their rutting at night. It is widely perceived that taking a mature bull is getting harder and harder each year.

A couple of years ago, word began to filter around hunters' campfires about a new calling technique called "cow talk." It was said that by imitating the sounds of a cow elk, or making herd noises, calling in a bull was more likely. The idea here was that these sounds were both intriguing and calming and would enable a hunter to bring in a bull that would not otherwise come in to a testimonials, have proven these claims to be true. Cow talk really does work.

Don Laubach of Gardiner, Montana, is responsible for this new technique. Don has lived among the elk all his life. He takes an elk every year, hunting with a bow. He does it with a cow call he designed, combined with a technique he developed for using the call. In **ELK TALK**, this revolutionary method of call is covered in depth, with Don's hunting and calling expertise thoroughly explored by the skillful writing of outdoor writer Mark Henckel.

**ELK TALK** extensively covers the technique of calf, cow, and bull talk. With the information supplied in its 202 pages, plus a call, a reader should be able to have the technique mastered by this coming season. Imagine being able to lure in a bull that normally would not respond to a bugle, a bull during the general season, or calming an alarmed bull. It may sound too good to be true, but **ELK TALK** will tell you how it can be done. The reader will also find many useful bits of information that do not relate directly to calling—enough to justify the purchase of **ELK TALK.** If you come home from hunting empty-handed more than you would like to or are interested in a new dimension of the proven bugling